

HR Documents & Numbering

How to issue letters, keep the register accurate, and manage document types.

For HR team Version 1.0 Last updated July 2026

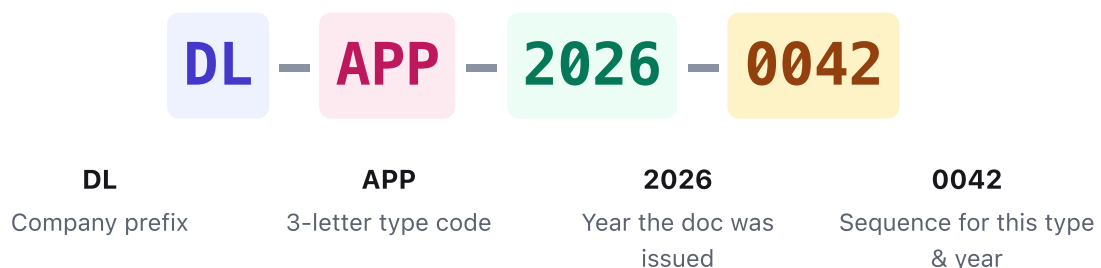
1 What this module is

Every formal letter HR issues — **appointment, experience, relieving, salary certificate, warning, increment, NOC, or anything ad-hoc** — now gets a unique number, an issue date, an issuer name, and (optionally) a link to the PDF. Two places to work with it:

SURFACE	WHAT LIVES THERE	WHO SEES IT
Employee profile → Documents tab	Every document ever issued to that one employee. Issue new ones from here.	Admin · HR Manager · HR Intern (read-only)
Sidebar → Documents (/hr/documents)	Register of every document across the org. Search / filter / jump to any employee.	Admin · HR Manager · HR Intern (read-only)

2 The numbering scheme

Every doc gets a unique number in this shape:



Sequence resets per **(type, year)**. So on 1 January 2027 the counter for every type restarts at `-0001`. Different types have their own sequences too — the first Experience letter of 2026 is `DL-EXP-2026-0001` regardless of how many appointment letters have already been issued.

NEVER REUSED

Voided numbers stay reserved. If you void `DL-APP-2026-0002`, the next appointment letter you issue gets `DL-APP-2026-0003` — not `-0002`. This keeps the audit trail honest; a gap in the sequence means "this number was voided," and you can look up why in the register.

3 Issuing a document

- 1 Open the employee's profile from **Sidebar → People**, then click the **Documents** tab.
- 2 Click **+ Issue Document** (top-right of the panel).
- 3 Fill in the modal:
 - **Document type** — Appointment / Experience / etc. Pick "Other" if it's an ad-hoc letter and provide a custom label.
 - **Issued on** — defaults to today. Change if you're backdating.
 - **Subject** — one line that shows on the register row (e.g. "Joining formalities" or "1-year completion").
 - **PDF link** — paste the shareable Google Drive / SharePoint URL to the actual PDF.
 - **Notes** — anything useful for the audit trail.
- 4 Click **Issue & allocate number**. A toast pops with the allocated number, e.g. `DL-APP-2026-0042`.
- 5 Rename the PDF file to include the number (e.g. `DL-APP-2026-0042 – Shubham – Appointment.pdf`) and re-upload to the same Drive location. The register keeps the URL pointing to it.

TWO AUTOMATIC THINGS HAPPEN

1. The employee gets an in-app notification ("Your appointment letter has been issued as DL-APP-2026-0042"). 2. If it's an appointment letter and the employee has an active onboarding checklist, the "Issue appointment letter" item auto-ticks. Same for experience / relieving letters and the offboarding checklist.

4 Fixing mistakes — edit vs void

Edit (small fixes)

Use edit when the number is correct but details need tweaking: change the **issued-on date**, update the **subject / notes**, swap the **PDF link**. Number, type, and employee stay locked — those define the identity of the document.

Void (real mistakes)

Use void when you issued the **wrong type**, sent it to the **wrong employee**, or generated the document by mistake. Voiding requires a short reason and the row stays in the register with a red "Voided" pill. Then issue a new document — it gets the next number in the sequence.

NEVER DELETE

There is no hard-delete on purpose. If the number could be freed up, an auditor couldn't tell "voided" from "never existed" — the register would lie by omission. The gap in the sequence is a feature, not a bug.

5 Finding a document later

Two ways in:

1. You know **whose** letter — open the employee's profile, Documents tab. All their docs are there in date order.
2. You know **the number** or **any keyword** — go to **Sidebar → Documents**. The search box hits the number, the subject, the notes, and the employee name. You can also filter by type and date range.

6 Managing document types

Standard types ship with the system. If you need to add, rename, hide, or reorder them, go to **Config → HR Doc Types** (admin + HR only).

ACTION	EFFECT
Add new type	Enter a label + optional 3-letter code. New type appears in the Issue Document dropdown immediately.
Rename label	Safe. Everyone sees the new label immediately. Past documents still resolve correctly.
Rename code (e.g. APP → APPL)	Safe. Past doc numbers stay literal (<code>DL-APP-2026-0001</code> keeps its "APP"). Only future issues use the new code.
Reorder	Up / down arrows. Order applies to the Issue dropdown.
Hide (eye toggle)	Type disappears from the Issue dropdown. Existing documents of that type still render everywhere. This is the "delete" — actual deletion is not allowed because it would orphan history.

RULE OF THUMB

Rename freely. Hide instead of delete. If you truly want to retire a type, hide it; don't try to make the row go away.

7 Standard types (shipped)

TYPE	CODE	TYPICAL WHEN
Appointment letter	APP	New joiner. Auto-ticks the onboarding item on issue.
Experience letter	EXP	On exit or on employee request for a completed tenure.
Relieving letter	REL	On last working day.
Salary certificate	SAL	On employee request (bank / visa / rental).
Warning letter	WRN	Formal disciplinary action.
Increment letter	INC	On salary revision.
NOC	NOC	Second job / education / visa purposes.
Other	OTH	Anything ad-hoc — you must add a custom label on issue.

8 Roles & permissions

ROLE	VIEW	ISSUE	EDIT / VOID	MANAGE TYPES
Admin	✓	✓	✓	✓
HR Manager	✓	✓	✓	✓
HR Intern	✓	—	—	—
Everyone else	—	—	—	—

Employees see notifications when a doc is issued to them but can't browse the register.

9 FAQ

Can I get the number before I've written the PDF?

Yes — the number is only allocated when you submit the modal. So the safest order is: draft the PDF locally with a placeholder name → issue in HRMS → get the number →

rename the PDF using that number → upload to Drive → paste the link into the register (edit the row).

What if I issued to the wrong employee?

Void the document with reason "wrong employee" and issue a new one against the correct person. The voided row stays in the register; auditors can see what happened.

Does the system generate the PDF for me?

No. You draft the PDF wherever you already do (Word / Google Docs / a template). The HRMS holds the number and the link. Keep the PDFs in Drive / SharePoint as you already do.

What if I forget to paste the Drive link on issue?

No harm — you can edit the row later and add the link. The number is what matters; the link is a convenience.

Can I see all the letters we've issued this year?

Yes. Open **Sidebar → Documents**, set the type filter to "All types," set the date range to Jan 1 → today. Export via browser print if you need a snapshot.

Employee says they didn't get the notification.

Check if they have an active login (they need an `app_users` row linked to their employee record). The register shows the issued-by name and time regardless; the notification is a courtesy.